

Warfarin

INR (International Normalized Ratio): A lab measurement of blood clotting ability used to monitor anticoagulation levels.

Thrombosis: Formation of blood clots in blood vessels.

Gingival bleeding: Bleeding from the gums.

Heparin

Myocardial infarction: Commonly known as a heart attack; caused by blocked blood flow to the heart.

Low molecular weight heparin: A specific type of heparin that is more stable and predictable in its action.

Direct Oral Anticoagulants (DOACs)

DVT (Deep Vein Thrombosis): Blood clot formation in deep veins, usually in the legs.

Half-life: The time it takes for the drug concentration in the body to reduce by half.

Aspirin

Platelet inhibitor: A substance that prevents platelets (blood components responsible for clotting) from clumping together.

Clopidogrel (Plavix)

Platelet aggregation: The clumping together of platelets in the blood to form clots.

Stent placement: A procedure to open blocked blood vessels using a small tube.

Dipyridamole

Prosthetic heart valves: Artificial heart valves surgically implanted to replace damaged ones.

General Precautions in Dental Practice for Anticoagulants

Hemostatic agents: Substances used to stop bleeding during and after surgery.

Bone wax: A material used to stop bleeding from bone surfaces during surgery.

Vasovagal Syncope

Vagus nerve: A nerve that helps control heart rate and blood pressure.

Arterial pressure: The pressure of blood in the arteries.

Peripheral vascular resistance: The resistance to blood flow in the smaller blood vessels.

Prodromal phase: Early symptoms that appear before the main symptoms.

Tachypnoea: Rapid breathing.

Bradycardia: Slow heart rate.

Pallor: Unnatural paleness of the skin.

Tachycardia: Fast heart rate.

Cardiac Syncope

Cardiac output: The amount of blood the heart pumps in a minute.

Complete heart block (Stokes-Adams-Morgagni syndrome): A condition where the electrical signals in the heart are blocked, causing the heart to beat abnormally.

Paroxysmal tachycardias: Sudden episodes of fast heart rate.

Sick sinus syndrome: A condition where the sinus node (the heart's natural pacemaker) doesn't work properly, causing slow or irregular heartbeats.

Aortic stenosis: Narrowing of the aortic valve in the heart, restricting blood flow.

Hypertrophic cardiomyopathy: A condition where the heart muscle becomes abnormally thick.

Primary pulmonary hypertension: High blood pressure in the lungs' arteries, which can strain the heart.

Pulmonary embolism: A blockage in one of the pulmonary arteries in the lungs, often caused by a blood clot.

Left atrial ball valve thrombus or myxoma: A clot or tumor in the left atrium of the heart that can obstruct blood flow.

Tetralogy of Fallot: A congenital heart defect involving four heart abnormalities.

Orthostatic Syncope

Postural hypotension: A drop in blood pressure when standing up.

Vasoconstrictor reflexes: Reflexes that cause blood vessels to narrow, raising blood pressure.

Postural syncope: Fainting due to a sudden drop in blood pressure when standing.

Diabetic neuropathy: Nerve damage caused by diabetes.

Tabes dorsalis: A form of syphilis that causes nerve damage, particularly to the spinal cord.

Haemorrhage: Excessive bleeding.

Vasodilators: Medications that relax and expand blood vessels.

Volume depletion: Loss of body fluids, leading to reduced blood volume.

Syncope Associated with Cerebrovascular Disease

Occlusion: Blockage or closing off of a blood vessel.

Neck arteries: Blood vessels that supply blood to the head and brain.

Brainstem: The part of the brain responsible for basic life functions such as heart rate and breathing.

Miscellaneous Causes of Syncope

Carotid sinus syncope: Fainting caused by pressure on the carotid sinus, located in the neck.

Vagal and glossopharyngeal neuralgia: Pain or discomfort due to irritation of the vagus nerve or glossopharyngeal nerve.

Micturition syncope: Fainting that occurs during or after urination.

Cough syncope: Fainting triggered by severe coughing, often in people with chronic bronchitis.

Hypoglycaemia: Low blood sugar levels.

Hyperventilation: Rapid or shallow breathing, often due to anxiety.

Hysterical fainting: Fainting caused by emotional stress or psychological factors.